DS: It is not true. I never had his number and never called him. Why am I being suspected, it could be anybody else if at all calls were made to Afzal or any other person. Afzal was sent to Pattan from my camp in September 2000 and I was transferred out from Humhama SOG camp to CIK [Counter Intelligence Kashmir] Hari Niwas in February 2001. When I was in Humhama SOG camp, there was no STD dialling facility there. I have not even visited that camp after my transfer. If I called Afzal from there who will authenticate it?

PB: Did anybody pay you money for Afzal's release as he has alleged?

DS: No. Even if I wanted to take money, I could not have as my SP's brother-in-law was seeking his [Afzal's] release. At the same time I cannot guarantee that nobody else took money from his family.

PB: In the light of allegations by Afzal, do you think that you may have been used?

DS: It is a difficult time for me. I would expect my superiors to clear my name. But it is sad that nobody from my department has come forward so far. Even if I had an iota of suspicion that I had been used by anybody, I am not the type to keep silent. And I want to reiterate that I have not talked to, seen or met Afzal or any of his family members after handing him back to Pattan SOG camp.

PB: Then why is your name figuring in Afzal's letter and his wife's accounts?

DS: I am being victimized for having worked in SOG, for being very nationalistic. What am I getting in return? Bad name and a conspirator . . . It's really unfortunate . . . Also, to be candid with you, nobody would ever forget having been interrogated by me.